

The Label on My Coat: answers

Year 6 · 15 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. Her name and age, and her brother's: Dorothy Ashby, aged eleven; Peter Ashby, aged six. (1 mark)

Finding information (2b). A detail to find in the middle of the story.

2. Not known or not seen before; strange or new. (1 mark)

Word meaning (2a). Working out a word from the context around it.

3. To comfort and calm Peter (and perhaps to reassure herself). (2 marks)

Inference (2d). Understanding why a character says something, which may not be the same as what they believe.

4. She was sad or worried, but she was pretending to be cheerful so the children would not be frightened. (2 marks)

Inference (2d). A short phrase that says one thing and suggests another.

5. She has been labelled and sent away like something being posted, rather than being treated like a child with a home and a family. (2 marks)

Language choices. Understanding a metaphor and the feeling behind it.

6. Any two of: she holds his hand; she tells him not to cry; she stays awake while he sleeps; she looks at him before answering the woman. (2 marks)

Inference (2d). Gathering evidence about a character from several places.

7. One mark each for: her feelings at the start (anxious, tight throat, putting on a brave front); a point where she is worried (the line of children, "nobody wanted to take two"); the change at the end (relieved, hopeful, shoulders relaxing, "Yes, please"). (3 marks)

Summarising (2c). Summarising how a character changes across a whole story.

8. She wanted to look strong or well behaved, and hoped to be chosen together with her brother. (2 marks)

Explaining from the text. A small action that reveals a character's hopes and fears.